

Dwayne Whitten - 2024

Strategic Engagement and Networking

My efforts in the past year focused on strengthening departmental-wide initiatives, leveraging the overlapping responsibilities as Director of the Flex Online MS-MIS program and Co-Director of CMIS. Corporate engagement remained central, with ongoing dialogues involving companies, current working students, and alumni, thereby fostering connections that benefit the entire department.

- **Guest Lectures and Tours:**
 - Organized six guest lectures across four distinct courses.
 - Planned an upcoming technical tour of Kyle Field for ISTM310 and ISTM655, featuring Aruba representatives and Daniel Roberts (Assistant AD for TAMU Athletics).
- **Corporate Collaboration:**
 - Advanced discussions with AWS to provide cloud services for departmental students and faculty.
 - Worked with Jana to create and maintain an inventory of over 500 former students and friends of the department for future engagement opportunities.

These strategic efforts not only expanded CMIS's corporate footprint but also enriched student learning experiences and promoted stronger industry ties that will continue to benefit departmental initiatives in the future.

Annual Review of Activities - 2024

CMIS (Council for the Management of Information Systems)

- **CMIS AI Conference:** Successfully launched the inaugural CMIS AI Conference, which became the first profitable CMIS event in recent years, raising over \$10,000 through registrations. This initiative has positioned CMIS as a thought leader in AI discussions within the industry. (The 2025 conference had over 200 in attendance and was even more financially successful)
- **Membership Growth:** Expanded CMIS membership by securing four new members: Palo Alto, Umbrage, Phillips66, and Booz Allen. This growth contributed to a net revenue increase of \$24,000, enhancing the financial health and outreach of the organization.
- **Key Events Organized:**
 - *February 23:* CMIS Leadership in Technology Conference
 - *February 29:* MIS Career Night
 - *April 11:* CMIS Board Meeting
 - *April 11-12:* CMIS Case Competition
 - *April 16:* Spring CMIS Social (New Event)

- *August 30:* Preparing for the Career Fair
 - *September 5:* Speed Networking and MIS Mixer
 - *September 6:* CMIS Career Fair
 - *October 10:* MIS Career Night
 - *November 14:* CMIS Board Meeting
 - *November 14-16:* CMIS Case Competition
 - *December 6:* Fall CMIS Social (New Event)
-
- Strategically refocusing our Fall events to be focused more on recruiting and the spring events to be more focused on building relationships between companies and students so they are ready to engage more easily once the recruiting season begins.

Departmental Contributions

- *Mentorship:* Served as a mentor to SK, providing guidance and professional development support.
- *Product Management Fireside Chat Series:* Initiated and organized a new speaker series, successfully hosting four distinguished speakers:
 - Anand Sridharan (Amazon) - September 21
 - Mike Hnatt (ShoWorks) - October 21
 - Hemanth Shekar (Rivian) - November 4
 - Lacey Baze (Texas A&M) - November 11
- *Marketing Initiatives:* Collaborated with Keystone to enhance marketing efforts for all three MS programs, focusing on international student recruitment.
- *INFO Department Road Show:* Hosted events in Dallas, San Antonio, Austin, and Houston for the second straight year. Former SCMT and MIS students invited to attend. An average of 75 people per event.
- *INFO Student Services Conference Room A/V:* Worked with TAMU ITS and vendors to get new audio/visual equipment.
- *LinkedIn engagement:* Worked with Jana and Sarah to increase engagement on the Department LinkedIn page. Two-three departmental post per day on average to announce upcoming events, event recaps, faculty and student recognition (published research, student jobs, etc), guest speakers, etc. The page currently has almost 3,000 followers and growing. A competitive analysis against other LinkedIn pages of Mays academic departments and competitor university departments shows we lead on all metrics or membership and engagement.

FOMIS (Flex Online MS-MIS Program)

- Achieved a substantial increase in program size, with the Class of 2026 growing over 300% compared to previous cohorts.
- Led efforts with faculty to review and improve course content, ensuring it meets current industry standards.

- Initiated planning for 2025 evening Fireside Chats with IT leaders to enhance student learning and industry engagement.

Personal Achievements

- Attended the AWS AI Conference on October 16, 2024, in Austin, expanding knowledge on AI advancements relevant to both academic and industry applications.
- Made significant course developments:
 - *ISTM630*: Converted one-third of the course to focus on Product Management.
 - *SCMT375*: Completely redesigned the course and developed recorded eLectures to enhance student engagement.
 - *SCMT675*: Developed and launched a new course.
 - *MS-SCAN*: Organized Walmart (WMT) tours for students, enhancing practical industry exposure.

Other Contributions

- Continued involvement in the 2023-25 HPRC GenCyber Camp, aimed at educating high school students about cybersecurity during summer camps.